

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory South Carolina

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:37:10 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- Action Steps: List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o Expected Completion Date: List the expected completion date for the action step.
- Overall Target Date for Compliance: List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

ELIGIBILITY AND ENROLLMENT:CONTINUITY OF CARE (12-MONTH ELIGIBILITY)

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not appropriately limit what families must report during the 12-month eligibility period to allowable information, as required by 98.21(h)(2). (Plan Question 2.5.4)

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/06/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Develop new language to be inserted in all areas of written documentation	12/13/2024
2	Review all written documents, policies, procedures, and manuals around reporting changes to identify where changes were needed.	12/13/2024
3	Send updated language to OCC for approval.	12/16/2024
4	Update all written documents, policies, procedures manuals and letters.	01/06/2025
5	Issue policy clarification to all child care staff.	01/06/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through April 30, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not pay based on enrollment or alternatively does not provide justification that this is impracticable or is not a generally-accepted practice, as required by 98.45(m)(2). (Plan Question 4.4.1b). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through April 30, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/06/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Program Staff Completed Mock-up Screens with brainstorming ideas about how to implement prospective payment and paying on enrollment vs. attendance. These two are to be implemented concurrently.	04/16/2024
2	Weekly meetings held with IT and Program staff	12/18/2024
3	Mass emails sent to child care providers along with a survey to providers to engage them in the process.	09/06/2024
4	Waiver submitted to OCC	08/22/2024
5	Extensive user acceptance testing by program staff and finance completed.	09/20/2024
6	Webinars and virtual office hours held with child care providers and child care staff. Webinar PowerPoint and information added to the website for providers and child care staff.	01/02/2025
7	Full implementation of prospective payments and paying on enrollment vs. attendance ☐ Go Live.	01/06/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through April 30, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/05/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
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1	Implementation Waiver Requested	08/22/2024
2	Implementation Waiver Approved	11/22/2024
3	Identify areas that need supply building for infants/toddlers, children with disabilities and underserved geographic areas.	03/01/2025
4	Conduct a needs assessment with enrolled Quality providers	04/01/2025
5	Determine service gaps.	06/01/2025
6	Hold information session with stakeholders for suggestions on how to maximize existing partnerships.	07/01/2025
7	Develop guidance around acceptable usage of slots, scope of work, etc. Identify internal process.	08/01/2025
8	Set-up agreements with and provide training to the child care providers. Review and update any printed documents and documents for website.	10/01/2025
9	Identify timelines for implementation.	11/01/2025
10	Fully implement.	01/05/2026

HEALTH AND SAFETY:BUILDING AND PHYSICAL PREMISES SAFETY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed family child care providers for compliance with a standard for building and physical premises safety, including the identification of and protection from hazards, bodies of water and vehicular traffic, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1bii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meetings with Central Office Team to discuss revisions to the licensed family child care provider inspection form.	01/31/2025

2	Meet with IT to communicate revisions of the family child care provider inspection form in the Child Care Licensing system.	02/05/2025
3	Meet with Licensing Staff at our quarterly ☐ Topic Tuesday ☐ training date for training on the licensed family child care provider inspection form.	03/18/2025
4	Communicate with family child care providers through email/bulletins/newsletters on the changes of the revised inspection form.	03/21/2025
5	Provide notification on the scchildcare.org website information regarding the revised licensed family child care home inspection form.	03/21/2025
6	Use of the form by Child Care Licensing staff will be fully implemented.	04/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS AND RESPONSE PLANNING

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with an emergency preparedness and response planning standard, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1a ii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meetings with Central Office Team to discuss revisions to the licensed child care center provider inspection form.	01/31/2025
2	Meet with IT to communicate revisions of the licensed child care center provider inspection form in the Child Care Licensing system.	02/05/2025
3	Meet with Licensing Staff at our quarterly ☐ Topic Tuesday ☐ training date for training on the	03/18/2025

	licensed child care center provider inspection form.	
4	Communicate with licensed child care center providers through email/bulletins/newsletters on the changes of the revised inspection form.	03/21/2025
5	Provide notification on the scchildcare.org website information regarding the revised licensed child care center provider inspection form.	03/21/2025
6	Use of the form by Child Care Licensing staff will be fully implemented.	04/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:HANDLING AND STORAGE OF HAZARDOUS MATERIALS AND DISPOSAL OF BIOCONTAMINANTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers and licensed family child care providers for compliance with a standard for handling and storage of hazardous materials and disposal of biocontaminants, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii and 5.5.1bii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meetings with Central Office Team to discuss revisions to the licensed family child care and licensed center inspection form.	01/31/2025
2	Meet with IT to communicate revisions of the licensed family child care and licensed center provider inspection form in the Child Care Licensing system.	02/05/2025
3	Meet with Licensing Staff at our quarterly □Topic Tuesday□ training date for training on the licensed family and licensed child care center provider inspection form.	03/18/2025
4	Communicate with licensed family and licensed child care center providers through	03/21/2025

	email/bulletins/newsletters on the changes of the revised inspection form.	
5	Provide notification on the scchildcare.org website information regarding the revised licensed family and licensed child care center provider inspection form.	03/21/2025
6	Use of the form by Child Care Licensing staff will be fully implemented.	04/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PRECAUTIONS IN TRANSPORTING CHILDREN

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed family child care providers for compliance with a precautions in transporting children standard, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1bii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meetings with Central Office Team to discuss revisions to the licensed family child care provider inspection form.	01/31/2025
2	Meet with IT to communicate revisions of the licensed family child care provider inspection form in the Child Care Licensing system.	02/05/2025
3	Meet with Licensing Staff at our quarterly □Topic Tuesday□ training date for training on the licensed family child care provider inspection form.	03/18/2025
4	Communicate with licensed family child care providers through email/bulletins/newsletters on the changes of the revised inspection form.	03/21/2025
5	Provide notification on the scchildcare.org website information regarding the revised licensed family child care provider inspection form.	03/21/2025

6	Use of the form by Child Care Licensing staff will be fully implemented.	04/01/2025
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HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION AND CONTROL OF INFECTIOUS DISEASES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed family child care providers for compliance with a standard for the prevention and control of infectious diseases (including immunizations), as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1bii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meetings with Central Office Team to discuss revisions to the licensed family child care provider inspection form.	01/31/2025
2	Meet with IT to communicate revisions of the licensed family child care provider inspection form in the Child Care Licensing system.	02/05/2025
3	Meet with Central Office Team to finalize the revisions to the licensed family child care provider's inspection forms.	03/18/2025
4	Communicate with licensed family child care providers through email/bulletins/newsletters on the changes of the revised inspection form.	03/21/2025
5	Provide notification on the scchildcare.org website information regarding the revised licensed family child care provider inspection form.	03/21/2025
6	Use of the form by Child Care Licensing staff will be fully implemented.	04/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION AND RESPONSE TO EMERGENCIES FROM FOOD AND ALLERGIC REACTIONS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care providers for compliance with a standard for prevention and response to emergencies from food and allergic reactions, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii and 5.5.1bii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meetings with Central Office Team to discuss revisions to the licensed family child care and licensed center inspection form.	01/31/2025
2	Meet with IT to communicate revisions of the licensed family and licensed child care center provider inspection form in the Child Care Licensing system.	02/05/2025
3	Meet with Licensing Staff at our quarterly □Topic Tuesday□ training date for training on the licensed family and licensed child care center provider inspection form.	03/18/2025
4	Communicate with licensed family and licensed child care center providers through email/bulletins/newsletters on the changes of the revised inspection form.	03/21/2025
5	Provide notification on the scchildcare.org website information regarding the revised licensed family and licensed child care center provider inspection form.	03/21/2025
6	Use of the form by Child Care Licensing staff will be fully implemented.	04/01/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY: RATIOS AND GROUP SIZE FOR CCDF PROVIDERS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with a group size standard, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1aii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Meetings with Central Office Team to discuss revisions to the licensed child care center provider inspection form.	01/31/2025
2	Meet with IT to communicate revisions of the licensed child care center provider inspection form in the Child Care Licensing system.	02/05/2025
3	Meet with Licensing Staff at our quarterly ☐ Topic Tuesday ☐ training date for training on the licensed child care center provider inspection form.	03/18/2025
4	Communicate with licensed child care center providers through email/bulletins/newsletters on the changes of the revised inspection form.	03/21/2025
5	Provide notification on the scchildcare.org website information regarding the revised licensed child care center provider inspection form.	03/21/2025
6	Use of the form by Child Care Licensing staff will be fully implemented.	04/01/2025